

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

turbulent emotions of new motherhood, with both of my children but especially with my second son.

But it never lasted. The brief buzz of a new purchase would quickly be replaced by worry about the financial implications, and logically I should have stopped, but the worse I felt, the more I spent. I would give myself a severe talking to one day, and go straight back to browsing H&M Home the next. Buying new clothes never made me happier with how I looked, just as covering my rented home with decorative homeware never made me feel less inadequate for not owning property. I was perpetually unsatisfied, always thinking that the next product would be the one that made me feel prettier, more stylish, happier. As I started to build a community, I learned that this is far from abnormal – that it's relatively common to have a complex and unhealthy relationship with spending. And, as with everything else about this process, knowing that I wasn't alone, feeling supported and understood for the first time, helped me to find the strength that I needed to challenge the way that I was doing things.

Broadly speaking, cycles of emotional spending tend to go like this: